

BLUE SCREEN OF DEATH LIVES ON

A gallery comprising screenshots of the infamous error appearing at the most inopportune moments (for Microsoft) throughout history. From Hoardings to airport flight schedule screens and even the Windows 98 launch ceremony! <http://zd.net/brqpdG>

2 BILLION NETIZENS

A United Nations agency recently found that number of Internet users will surpass two billion by the end of this year. That's a third of the world's population connected! Read this report on how developing countries need to step up access. <http://reut.rs/cf2wYA>



SMARTPHONE PHOTOGRAPHY

That dSLRs can take good shots could be a wrong assumption, after all. With the rate at which pixelage and image processing is constantly improving in smartphones, it's not at all surprising that Wired Magazine's recent iPhoneography contest got some awesome entries. Check out the gallery for winners and other pictures that were handpicked by Wired. <http://bit.ly/bFbjV4>

Here are several things to be aware of

When you overclock a PC, you can no longer truly count on it being stable. The PC was not designed to run with different things at different clock rates that aren't necessarily compatible with each other. What you gain in performance you lose in peace of mind: This thing could crash at any moment.

Never overclock a PC with critical data on it. Overclocking affects the memory and the CPU, and those in turn affect data written on the hard drive. Overclocking can end with corrupted data. You could lose stuff. Keep your overclocking relegated to gaming machines, graphics workstations—anything except a PC with mission-critical or personally valuable data on it. If you do choose to overclock your everyday PC, make

sure you back up your important data on a regular basis.

To get Prime95 to run on multiple cores, you must first tweak the desktop shortcut and then tweak the running program. First, open the desktop shortcut properties sheet and the command line switch Ax to the end of the Target box, where x = the number of instances you need to run (2 for a dual-core, 4 for a quad-core, etc.) Then, launch the program as many times as you need. Finally, in each instance of the program, click Advanced, go to Affinity, and the Specific CPU to run on box, enter 0 for the first core in the first instance and click OK; 1 for the second core in the second instance; and so on. Then you can start your CPU torture tests.

When torture-testing the CPU, monitor the temperature with whatever monitoring tool came with your motherboard. If you don't have a monitoring tool, go to the motherboard's manufacturing page, find the downloads for your specific model, and download the utility.

If you overclock too high and the PC won't POST, you have to reset the CMOS. There's usu-



Overclocking on an ASUS motherboard

ally a switch or a jumper on the motherboard specifically for this purpose. If, for some reason, the switch or jumper doesn't work, or there isn't one at all, power down the PC, unplug it, open the case, and pop out the small, round, disc-shaped battery for about ten minutes. Then, replace it and power back up. The BIOS setup program will be at pure defaults.

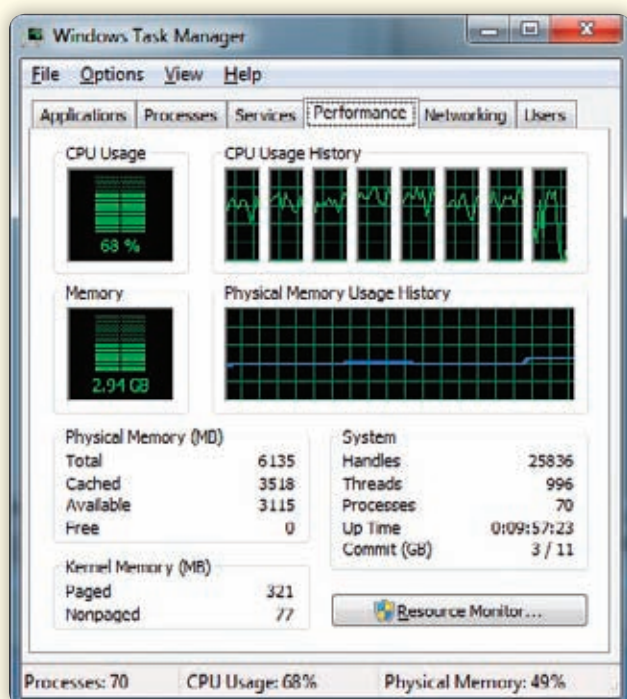
Overclocking doesn't raise the amount of voltage a power supply draws from the wall. We purchased a power meter and tested an overclocked system that drew 119 watts before overclocking, and drew 120 watts while overclocked at 10 percent over spec

Overclocking a CPU

First off, let's get this out of the way: There are utilities that allow you to overclock a CPU through a Windows desktop.

Ignore them.

Changing the speed your computer runs at on the fly can sometimes result in a system freeze or crash. Even worse, there have been times we have used such a utility, rebooted, and encountered a machine unable to POST. Do your overclocking through the BIOS setup utility. Trust us.



Windows Task Manager